

Hummingbird

—for Patricia C. Willis

Hummingbird is
not the best word, buzz-
ing as the glint-bit does.

The Mayan name
is optimum—
Dzunuuume!

Some species bring to mind
(to your mind, scholar-friend)
Miss Moore's attempts for Ford:

Hyacinth visorbearer,
Andean hillstar,
Bronze-tailed plumeleteer.

They work hard at what they do—
like you—
which is to

find, hover, feed
deep-down, and head
for more of what they need.

(Another fact, a facet, a surprise!)
And this requires,
the ornithologist I'm reading says,

the most energy-demanding flight,
the relatively largest heart
of any bird, of any sort.

By Jeredith Merrin
Previously unpublished.